

Troubleshooting

THIS DOCUMENT IS NOT MEANT TO BE GIVEN TO YOUR CLIENT

Miscellaneous

CLIENT IS ALLERGIC TO BENZOYL PEROXIDE

Instruct your client put a quarter size amount of **Advanced Acne Med** on the inside of one arm for 3 days in a row to see if there is a reaction. If the client observes a reaction prior to the 3 days, have them stop. A reaction would appear as itching, swelling, or burning associated with a rash. If there is no reaction after 3 days, they are not allergic to benzoyl peroxide. Many people think they are allergic to benzoyl peroxide because they have used it overnight immediately in the past. If they experience excessive dryness (not an allergy) you can have them go more slowly when acclimating in the beginning.

- Use the **Retinal B3 Serum** for noninflamed acne.
- Use oxygen emulsion in place of **Advanced Acne Med** (benzoyl peroxide).
See The Acne HQ > Downloads > Protocols > Supplier Resources Document.

CLIENT USED PRESCRIPTION TOPICAL PRODUCTS PRIOR TO SEEING YOU

- When a client books their first appointment with you, instruct them to stop using any topical prescription products for at least 2 weeks before their first appointment.
- When you see them for their first appointment and their skin is still sensitive after discontinuing prescription topicals for 2 weeks, you can go more slowly with active products, even with serums. If they are sensitive to all serums, don't start them with one. The **Advanced Acne Med** (benzoyl peroxide) will make their skin less sensitive over time. You can start timing the **Advanced Acne Med** with just 5 minutes on the first night and add 5 minutes more each night. Retest the serums later.

IMPATIENT CLIENT WHO WANTS TO BE CLEAR IN 2 WEEKS

- Remind your client that it can take at least 3 months, and up to 6 months, to see significant clearing of their skin.
- It takes 30 to 90 days for a microcomedone to surface and acne will continue to come to the surface during the first 4 months on the program.

Dryness and peeling:

Tell the client from the outset that they will most likely have temporary dryness and peeling on their way to getting clear. Any product that is strong enough to get acne under control is inherently drying. Encourage them to be patient with a bit of dry skin. If it gets uncomfortably dry, or any product is stinging or burning, instruct them to contact you immediately.

- **Use petroleum jelly:** a common symptom of using benzoyl peroxide is dryness around the mouth and chin area. When that happens, instruct your client to put a thin layer of petroleum jelly on the dry area before they apply their **Advanced Acne Med**. They can do this for 2 to 3 days and then resume the **Advanced Acne Med** there again. Reassure your client that petroleum jelly will not cause breakouts.
- **Make sure the client is using hydraRemedy™ Gel Serum** and their serum then **Barrier Care Gel Cream**, **clearDerma Moisturizer**, or **Cran-Peptide Cream** in the morning before sunscreen. Have the client use **hydraRemedy™ Gel Serum** before their serum and add **Barrier Care Gel Cream**, **clearDerma Moisturizer**, or **Cran-Peptide Cream** after **Advanced Acne Med** at night. If they are still experiencing dryness after implementing these suggestions, they can use **hydraRemedy™ Gel Serum** before AND after their serums, both morning and night. This technique is called **Hydrastack**.
- Switch the client's cleanser to **Barrier Balance Creamy Cleanser** if they are not already using it.

INCONSISTENT OR IMPROPER PRODUCT USAGE

If a client is not getting clear or staying clear, the first thing to check is check how they are applying their home care:

- Make sure clients are applying their serum with their hands, not a cotton ball or cotton round.
- Make sure clients are applying Advanced Acne Med all over their face and not just spot treating.
- Make sure clients are applying products in the right order.
- Make sure clients are putting enough product.

If that checks out, the next step is to check their product purchase history. **90%** of the time the clients are using their home care products inconsistently. Check their Advanced Acne Med purchases first, and exfoliating serum purchases next. Compare their purchase history to the **Normal Product Usage Timetable**.



NORMAL PRODUCT USAGE TIMETABLE

PRODUCT	USAGE – 1X DAILY	USAGE – 2X DAILY
1.5 oz Advanced Acne Med dime to nickel size	6-9 weeks	3-5 weeks
1.5 oz Sulfur Spot Treatment ½ pea size	Use as needed	
1 oz Serums 1 pump	16 weeks	8 weeks
6 oz Cleanser dime to nickel size	Must use 2x daily	8-10 weeks
6 oz Toner nickel to quarter size	Must use 2x daily	10-12 weeks
1.7 oz Hydrator 1-2 pumps	10 weeks	5 weeks
2 oz Moisturizer pea to nickel size	12 weeks	6 weeks
2 oz Sunscreen length of longest finger size	10 weeks	N/A
.12 mL Eye Gel ½ pea size	8 weeks	4 weeks
2.5 oz Mask quarter size	Use as needed	

If the client's product purchase history and the **Normal Product Usage Timetable** show that the client is being inconsistent with the home care product usage, explain why consistency is crucial. Next, find out why the client isn't being consistent. It could be:

- Skipping home care because of dryness/dehydration/products stinging
- Skipping home care because of budget
- Skipping home care because of schedule

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Skiping Home Care due to Dryness, Dehydration, or Stinging Products

*Ideally, the client needs to be able to use their exfoliating serum twice a day and **Advanced Acne Med** once a day, to get clear and stay clear. You will need to find a home care routine that will allow for this.*

- Ask if any of their products are stinging or burning. If so, change that product. Sometimes it can be a mild non-active (like toner or sunscreen) causing the problem.
- Ask if they are skipping products when they get dry. If so, the home care routine is too strong.
 - **Make sure the client is using Barrier Care Gel Cream, clearDerma Moisturizer, and/or Cran-Peptide Cream** in the morning (if not using **Advanced Acne Med**) and **hydraRemedy™ Gel Serum** at night after the serum and before the **Advanced Acne Med**. They can also layer **hydraRemedy™ Gel Serum** under their moisturizer in the morning. If they still are experiencing dryness after implementing the suggestions about, they can use **hydraRemedy™ Gel Serum** before AND after their serums, both morning at night. This technique is called **Hydrastack**.
- Consider giving them a milder cleanser and/or toner.
- Adjust down active products (serums and **Advanced Acne Med**) **after** non-actives. Make sure to always test new serums on the skin before giving it to the client. If their current product is not stinging or burning, they do not need to return the product. They can use it later, when their skin has adjusted and is no longer as dry (even once or twice a week as a booster).
- If the client has inflamed acne, consider giving them an oxygen emulsion cream to use in the morning instead of **Advanced Acne Med**. Oxygen emulsion creams usually come in a moisturizing base so it will not exacerbate dryness. Remember when the weather gets colder, skin becomes drier and cannot always tolerate the same products. **See The Acne HQ > Downloads > Protocols > Supplier Resources Document** to find a suggestion for an oxygen emulsion cream.

Skiping Home Care due to Budget or Money Issues

If a client is having consistency issues because of cost, we can make the following suggestions:

- Always spend the money on products before treatments.
- If they can't afford to come in at all, offer to do virtual appointments or connect via email. Ask them to check in with you every 2 weeks and include pictures.
- Make sure they are not using any non-Face Reality products that might contain pore- clogging ingredients (cleansers, benzoyl peroxide, sunscreen).
- Take the toner out of their routine temporarily as a last resort.

Skiping Home Care due to Schedule

If a client is having consistency issues because of their schedule, find out what is getting in the way. Brainstorm with the client to find a way around the issue.

- If they absolutely cannot use **Advanced Acne Med** consistently at night, move it to their morning routine. Instruct the client to wait 15 minutes after applying **Advanced Acne Med** to apply sunscreen.
- If they are not able to do a multi-step routine in the morning, advise them to just use their actives at night. Remind them it may take longer to get clear without using actives twice a day.



LIFESTYLE ISSUES

If your client is using their home care products consistently and is still not getting clear, it is time to review lifestyle choices. Even if a client initially was using makeup that was noncomedogenic or using a form of birth control that is less likely to exacerbate acne, they may have changed since they were last asked. Here are some reasons a client may not be clearing if it is not due to inconsistent product usage:

- Do they check in with you to adjust their routine at 2-week intervals?
- Did they change their routine on their own without consulting you first?
- Are they using non-Face Reality products?
- Are they using comedogenic makeup?
- Are they using comedogenic hair care?
- Are they using fabric softener or dryer sheets in the washer and/or the dryer?
- Are they consuming dairy/soy products: milk, cheese, and/or yogurt?
- Are they consuming protein shakes or protein bars made from whey or soy that contain iodine?
- Are they consuming sushi, seaweed, iodized salt, spirulina, or chlorella?
- Are they consuming high androgen foods like peanuts, peanut butter, shellfish, or organ meat?
- Are they smoking marijuana?
- Are they exposed to any chemicals: coal tars, grease in restaurants or auto mechanic shops, dioxin, or chlorinated chemicals?
- Do they regularly wear hats, helmets, or shoulder pads?
- Are they under more stress than usual and/or getting enough sleep?
- Are they taking any medications or drugs or have any medical condition that they haven't yet disclosed to you?
- Are they taking the Face Reality Clear Skin Balance and Clear Skin Restore supplements as recommended by their Acne Expert?
- Are they taking vitamins or supplements that may contain iodides and/or biotin?
- Are they on birth control pills or another form of birth control?

If questions 15 – 18 are impacting their ability to get clear, provide them with information about options that are not associated with exacerbating acne. **Always instruct the client to speak with their doctor before starting or stopping any supplements, vitamins, medications, or forms of birth control.**

If the client is not being compliant with lifestyle issues is keeping the client from getting clear or staying clear, give them a copy of the **Getting Clear and Staying Clear** document. Highlight which lifestyle issues need addressing. If inconsistent product usage is also an issue, highlight that on the document as well. Inconsistent clients should also receive a copy of the **Normal Product Usage Timetable** with their purchase history written on it. Write which documents are given in their acne treatment notes. If you have to give them these documents too many times, it may be time to tactfully end your relationship with them.



HANDLING A MINOR WHO IS NOT CLEARING

- If you have a minor who is not clearing due to inconsistent product use and/or lifestyle issues, ask what is keeping them from being consistent. Find out if there is an issue you can help them work around.
- If the parent is not in the room, speak with the parent after the appointment to let them know what the issues are.
 - They often believe the minor is being compliant. Inform them about inconsistent product usage or lifestyle issues that are causing problems.
 - If the parent is not with the minor for the appointment, send an email letting them know what the issues are.
 - If the situation can't be changed, suggest to the parent that they bring the minor back when they are ready to be consistent.

LED'S

If a client has inflamed acne that is not clearing after 2 months AND they have been compliant with their home care, you can lend them an LED handheld light. It can help to reduce inflammation. **You can find Face the Reality's LED Agreement Form The Acne HQ>Downloads>Client Handouts to see how the Face Reality Acne Clinic handles lending out LED lights.**